

Chris Schulz

Team Lead | Product Manager | AI Engineer | AI Officer | Data Scientist | Data Strategist |

✉ chris.schulz13@yahoo.de | 📱 deadhand777 | 🌐 chris-schulz-ai-first

💻 deadhand777.github.io/data-alpha | 📍 Potsdam, Germany



Head of Data & AI with 10+ years taking AI from experiment to production in regulated FinTech and financial services. Cut after-contact work by 25%, lifted development productivity by 40%, and built AI governance ready for EU AI Act enforcement. Builds the teams alongside the systems.

Professional Experience

Dr Klein Ratenkredit GmbH

HEAD OF DATA & AI

Lübeck, Germany

May 2023 – Present

- Built the data and AI strategy around the company's business goals and rolled it into day-to-day decision-making
- Built a production AI platform for Intelligent Document Processing (IDP) on Strands Agents SDK and Amazon Bedrock AgentCore, with model serving, a REST API layer, and CI/CD pipelines; it cut after-contact work by 25%
- Designed a distributed datalakehouse (AWS S3, Glue, Lake Formation, Firehose, DuckDB, Iceberg) with automated quality monitoring and observability; analytics, ML training, and product data access across the company all run on it
- Established an AI governance framework for the EU AI Act: model documentation, audit trails, explainability pipelines, and continuous bias monitoring for production decisioning systems
- Rolled out Claude Code across the engineering team, which raised software development productivity by 40%
- Shipped an ISMS and compliance agent (Bedrock AgentCore, Strands Agents, Claude Haiku 4.5, eu-central-1 for EU data residency). It answers information security and regulatory questions from the internal ISMS knowledge base with cited sources, using a vectorless manifest-then-fetch retrieval pattern
- Delivered a self-service data analyst agent (AgentCore runtime, Strands Agents, CDK) that answers natural-language questions over the internal datalakehouse under existing data governance, so business stakeholders no longer queue for an analyst
- Hired and led a 6-person AI engineering team, and set its engineering standards, sprint cadence, and delivery model; a few structured technical training all 6 engineers run platform components on their own, with 80% more efficient workflows

Amazon Bedrock AWS Claude Datalakehouse EU AI Act GenAI LLM MCP Model Governance Python Strands Agents TypeScript AI Chatbot Information Security Compliance Regulatory AI NLP LLM Applications Data Analytics Business Intelligence

Allgeier IT GmbH

SOFTWARE DATA SCIENTIST SOCIAL CONTACT

Berlin, Germany

Dec 2022 – May 2023

- Defined the data strategy and roadmap for a client's customer service department: collected the main business requirements and matched data capabilities to their operational goals
- Designed a cloud data management framework covering the ingestion, transformation, and consumption layers, so teams across the client could serve themselves

Cloud Architecture Consulting Data Strategy Python Business Intelligence

Deutsche Kreditbank AG (DKB)

HEAD DATA SCIENTIST

Berlin, Germany

Jul 2022 – Nov 2022

- Led and mentored a team of data scientists at one of Germany's largest digital retail banks; set the model development workflow, code review standards, and a deployment checklist for regulated production ML in banking
- Developed the data science strategy and product roadmap for DKB's core banking AI initiatives within BaFin-regulated risk and compliance constraints

BaFin Banking Data Science Strategy Data Science Workflow Python R Regulated ML Team Leadership Business Intelligence

Europace AG

DATA SCIENTIST TEAM LEAD | HEAD SECTIONAL DATA MANAGER

Berlin, Germany

Jan 2021 – Jul 2022

- Led Europace's data strategy transformation and took it into every business unit
- Extended a central data lake with modular services that gave every Europace stakeholder group self-serve analytics
- Built ML anomaly detection and time series forecasting pipelines that automate data validation and feed capacity planning into executive reporting

Anomaly Detection AWS Datalake ML Python Team Leadership Time Series TypeScript Business Intelligence

DATA SCIENTIST TOP LEVEL OWNERS SECTIONAL DATA MANAGER

Jun 2020 – Jan 2021

- Designed the cloud data framework (ingestion, transformation, consumption) for the loans business and built KPI dashboards across teams, which started data-driven decision-making at Europace

AWS Datalake ETL KPI Design ML Product Deployment Python TypeScript Business Intelligence

DATA ANALYST | OPERATIONAL BUSINESS UNIT

Aug 2016 – Jun 2020

- Advised partner institutions on technology and data capability; led the Europace data-drivenness initiative across the lending ecosystem

Cerulli Associates

Quantitative Analysis

London, UK

Oct 2015 – Aug 2016

- Sourced, validated, and analyzed data to produce client insights
- Calibrated models and ran market sizing and forecasts for European markets and asset classes
- Researched distribution trends in institutional asset management along the investment chain, which clients used to calibrate their market penetration strategies

Campaign Management Financial Markets Forecasting Institutional Asset Management Quantitative Analysis Business Intelligence

Lloyds Banking Group

Business Intelligence

Berlin, Germany

Mar 2014 – Oct 2015

- Designed asset allocation framework for an investment project targeting mass affluent clientele
- Developed a portfolio of investment vehicles covering the whole customer spectrum
- Created a selection algorithm that weighs customer preferences against qualitative and quantitative ETF characteristics to give tailored investment advice

Asset Allocation Deposit Insurance ETF Financial Services Investment Project Management Retail Banking Business Intelligence

Alstom Power

Project Management

Zurich, Switzerland

Dec 2013 – Mar 2014

- Supported control and budgeting of the full project lifecycle from construction to commissioning of EMEA power plants, holding 4 projects to budget
- Produced and presented financial forecasts, construction reviews, cost calculations, and database updates for project stakeholders

Budgeting Controlling Financial Forecasting Project Management

Education

Leipzig University

Master of Science

Leipzig, GER / London, UK

Oct 2011 – Oct 2013

- Key areas: finance, accounting and taxation
- Dissertation: Portfolio Management and Overlay Strategies in Practice
- Semester abroad within Erasmus exchange program (University of East London)

Leipzig University

Bachelor of Science & Master of Science

Leipzig, GER

Oct 2008 – Oct 2011

- Key areas: accounting, finance, macroeconomics
- Dissertation: Information Content of Lagged Equity and Bond Yields

Skills

Generative AI & LLMs

GenAI Patterns (RAG, Agents, Chain-of-Thought, ReAct, DSPy) | LLM Frameworks (Agno, CrewAI, HuggingFace, LangChain, LangGraph, LlamaIndex, Strands Agents) | Models & APIs (Anthropic, Amazon Bedrock AgentCore, HuggingFace, Ollama) | LLM Ops (Deployment, Monitoring) | Fine-tuning (PEFT, LoRA, QLoRA, RLHF, DPO, Unsloth) | Vector Databases (Amazon S3 Vectors, ChromaDB, FalkorDB, Qdrant) | Model Context Protocol (MCP Server Implementation, Client Integration)

ML & Data Science

Languages (Python, R, SQL, TypeScript) | Classical ML (Regression, Classification, Clustering, XGBoost, LightGBM, Scikit-learn) | Deep Learning (PyTorch, TensorFlow, Neural Networks, Transformers) | Time Series (Forecasting, Classification, Anomaly Detection, Nixtla) | Data Visualization (Plotly, Streamlit, Shiny) | Platform Engineering (Model Serving, API Design, Pipeline Orchestration, Standardized Deployment) | AWS (S3, Glue, Athena, DynamoDB, Firehose, ECS, Lambda, EventBridge, SageMaker) | Data Processing (Arrow, DuckDB, Apache Iceberg, Apache Spark, Pandas, Polars) | Databases (PostgreSQL, MongoDB, ElasticSearch, Redshift) | DevOps & Tools (Docker, Git, CI/CD via GitHub Actions, AWS CDK, Claude Code)

Platform & Data Eng.

Leadership & Strategy

Team Building (AI Engineers, Data Engineers, ML Engineers, Hiring, Mentoring, Agile/Scrum) | Operating Model (Delivery Excellence, Engineering Standards, Cross-market Rollout) | Strategy (AI Roadmap, Data Strategy, Platform Vision, Stakeholder Management)

Regulation

Regulation & Compliance (Data Protection, Data Privacy, Data Governance, Model Governance) | EU AI Act Compliance | Model Governance & Auditability | GDPR-Compliant ML Pipelines | Explainable AI (XAI) | Continuous Bias Monitoring | Data Quality Evaluation